

Yutong (Max) Zhu

Division of the Social Sciences, University of Chicago

☎ +1 (412) 613-8313 | ✉ maxzhuyt@uchicago.edu

EDUCATION

University of Chicago <i>Ph.D., Sociology</i>	Chicago, IL <i>Expected 2031</i>
University of Chicago <i>M.A., Computational Social Science</i>	Chicago, IL <i>Jun 2025</i>
Carnegie Mellon University <i>B.S. (University Honors), Computer Science; Additional Major in Social and Political History</i>	Pittsburgh, PA <i>May 2022</i>

PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

≡ Indicates equal contribution and shared first authorship.

- [2] Sui, Peiqi[≡], **Yutong Zhu**[≡], Tianyi Cheng, Peter West, Richard Jean So, Hoyt Long, and Ari Holtzman. [Spoiler Alert: Narrative Forecasting as a Metric for Tension in LLM Storytelling](#). *Under review at the Conference on Language Modeling (COLM)*.
- [1] **Zhu, Yutong** (2025). Explaining Gendered Language Through Embedding Approximation: How “Stupid” Became a Man’s Word. *Revise and resubmit at Social Forces*.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- [2] **Zhu, Yutong**, Tianyi Zhang, Junsol Kim, Aaron Schein, and James Evans. The Zeitgeist Machine: Partisan Opinion Landscapes from Language Model Activations. *Manuscript in preparation*.
- [1] Evans, James, Shilin Jia, Rochelle Terman, and **Yutong Zhu**. The Nations in Our Minds: Historical Representations of Countries in Google Books. *Manuscript in preparation*.

PRESENTATIONS

- [3] **Zhu, Yutong** (2025, August). Explaining Gendered Language Through Embedding Approximation: How “Stupid” Became a Man’s Word. *Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association*. Chicago, IL.
- [2] **Zhu, Yutong** (2025, March). The Nations in Our Minds: Historical Representations of Countries in Google Books. *Annual Convention of the International Studies Association*. Chicago, IL.
- [1] **Zhu, Yutong** (2024, September). Between Min and Zu: Ethnonym and National Narrative in Post-Imperial China. *Midwest Conference on Asian Affairs*. University of Notre Dame, IN.

HONORS & AWARDS

University Scholar Full-Tuition Scholarship , University of Chicago	2023–2025
Ludwig Schaefer Award for Outstanding Achievement in History , Carnegie Mellon University	2022
Dietrich College Senior Honors Fellowship , Carnegie Mellon University	2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Chicago
Large-Scale Computing for the Social Sciences (Spring 2025), Prof. Jon Clindaniel, Prof. Fabricio Vasselai
Perspectives on Computational Modeling (Winter 2025), Prof. Zhao Wang

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Journal of Asian Studies <i>Editorial Assistant (Part-Time)</i>	Remote <i>Mar 2023 – Jun 2025</i>
Stellar Cyber <i>Data Engineer</i>	San Jose, CA <i>Jun 2022 – Feb 2023</i>

SKILLS

Methods: Data Management, Quantitative & Qualitative Research, Academic Writing, Data Analysis & Pipeline, Machine Learning, NLP

Technical: Python, C, Java, SPARQL, SQL, Kubernetes, Git; Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign

Languages: Mandarin (native), French (intermediate), Uzbek (elementary)

REFERENCES

James Evans

Max Palevsky Professor of Sociology & Data Science
University of Chicago
jevans@uchicago.edu

John Levi Martin

Florence Borchert Bartling Professor, Sociology
University of Chicago
jlmartin@uchicago.edu